As shown in figure 6.2, `my_cars_alias` is the alternate (second) name of the `cars_for_aliases` index. All query operations performed on the index so far can be redirected to `my_cars_alias` going forward. For example, we can index a document or search on this alias, as shown in the figure.

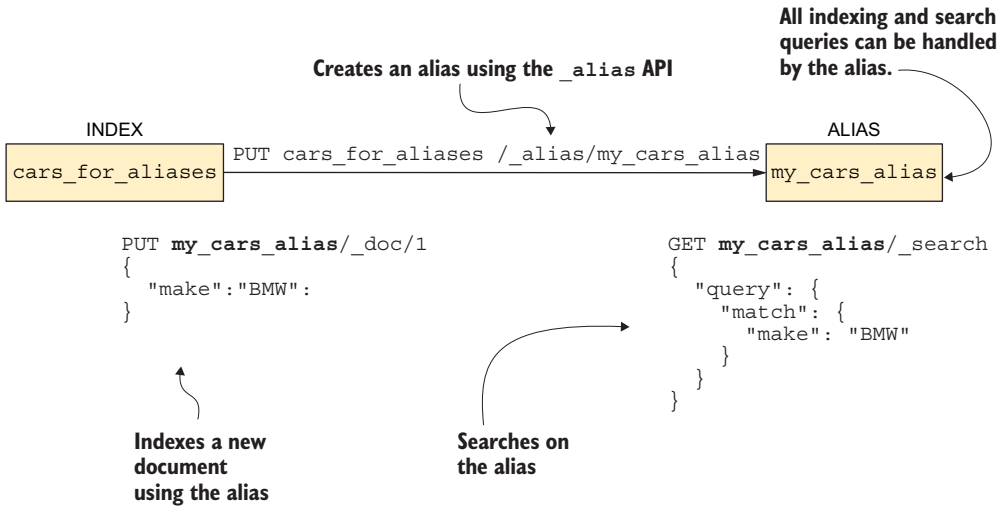


Figure 6.2 Creating an alias for an existing index

We can also create a single alias pointing to multiple indexes (see figure 6.3), including indexes provided with a wildcard. Listing 6.14 shows the code that creates an alias (`multi_cars_alias`). This, in turn, points to multiple indexes (`cars1,cars2,cars3`). Note that one of these indexes must be a write index.

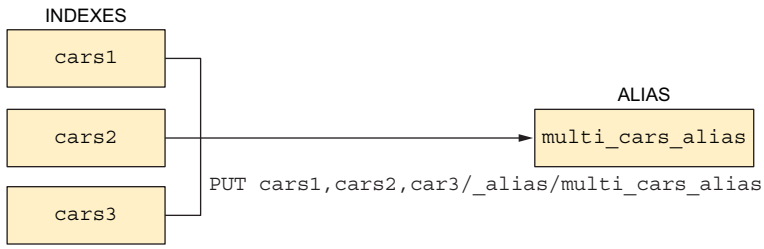


Figure 6.3 Creating an alias pointing to multiple indexes

Listing 6.14 Creating a single alias pointing to multiple indexes

```
PUT cars1,cars2,cars3/_alias/multi_cars_alias
```

Comma-separated indexes list